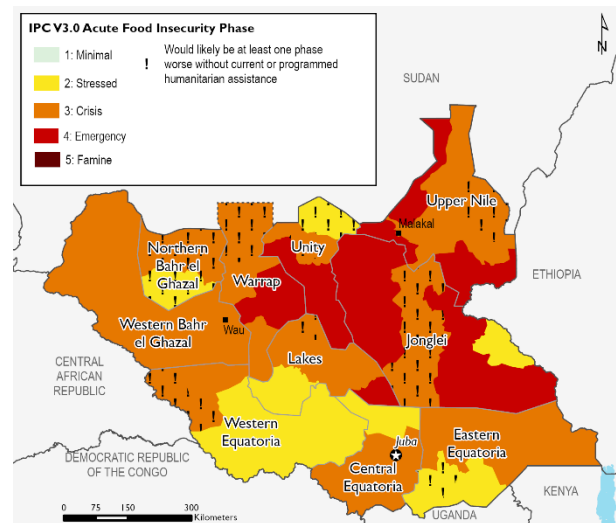


Emergency (IPC Phase 4) likely to continue in areas severely affected by conflict and floods

KEY MESSAGES

- The 2021 harvest, economic reforms that have led to a decline in staple food prices, and sustained humanitarian food assistance have driven a relative improvement in food availability and access in some areas of South Sudan. Food insecurity has likely improved from Crisis (IPC Phase 3) to Stressed (IPC Phase 2) in parts of the Equatorias and parts of Lakes and Jonglei where relative calm and conducive rainfall enabled this year's harvests to perform favorably. In several counties, significant food assistance is likely helping to compensate for shortfalls in crop production, leading to Stressed! (IPC Phase 2!) outcomes.
- Across the rest of South Sudan, however, FEWS NET estimates 55-65 percent of the national population faces Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes. Since June, multiple conflict and flood shocks have displaced hundreds of thousands of households and caused widespread crop and livestock losses, disruptions to markets and trade, and periodic constraints to food assistance delivery. Available ground information and historical crop production data suggest the 2021 harvest is either slightly better than or comparable to last year and the five-year average, with large cereal deficits occurring in conflict- and flood-affected areas. While food assistance is mitigating the severity of food insecurity for many people, the scale of need still outpaces food assistance levels. As a result, seasonal improvement in food security is marginal for most of the country, leaving most households exposed to food consumption gaps and atypically high acute malnutrition.
- Further deterioration in food insecurity is expected across South Sudan as harvest stocks become depleted between October and May. New information from WFP indicates food assistance funding will likely support plans to reach up to 11 percent of the national population between October and December; however, given that these plans are only newly available, further analysis is required to determine the likely impact on food security outcomes. Regardless, the gap between the population in need and planned distributions remains very wide. Moreover, assistance plans are not available from January onward. Food assistance must be scaled up and sustained to save lives and rebuild livelihoods.
- The areas of highest concern in South Sudan include Pibor, the greater Tonj area in Warrap, southern Unity, northern Jonglei, Tambura in Western Equatoria, and parts of Upper Nile, where FEWS NET assesses large populations are likely to be in Emergency (IPC Phase 4). Based on past trends and the severity and scale of ongoing shocks, some of the worst-affected households in remote, inaccessible, or insecure areas are likely to experience Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5)¹.
- While it is not the most likely scenario, there is a risk of Famine (IPC Phase 5) in areas with large populations in Emergency (IPC Phase 4). Past events in South Sudan demonstrate the potential for new shocks to isolate households from food sources and lead to extreme food insecurity. An end to conflict, accompanied by humanitarian interventions to rebuild livelihoods, resilience, and coping capacity, is required to reduce the risk of Famine (IPC Phase 5).

Current food security outcomes, October 2021



Source: FEWS NET

FEWS NET classification is IPC-compatible. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners.

¹ The IPC classifies acute food insecurity at the household level and area level. At the household level, Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) occurs when a household group has an extreme lack of food and/or other basic needs even after full employment of coping strategies. At the area level, Famine (IPC Phase 5) occurs when at least 20 percent of the households in a given area have an extreme lack of food; the Global Acute Malnutrition prevalence, as measured by weight-for-height z-score, exceeds 30 percent; and mortality, as measured by the Crude Death Rate (CDR), is greater than 2 per 10,000 per day.

Recurrent conflict and flood shocks sustain a risk of Famine (IPC Phase 5) in South Sudan

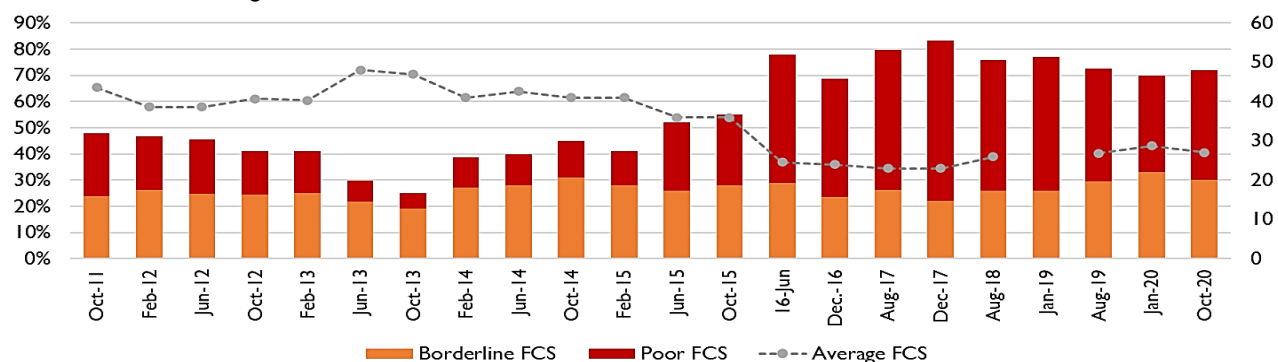
Recurrent sub-national conflict and a third consecutive year of devastating floods, amid protracted economic challenges, have continued to drive very high food assistance needs in South Sudan throughout 2021, peaking in the range of 7-8 million people. An uptick in political conflict and recurrent inter-communal conflict led to large-scale displacement in both established conflict hotspots, such as the greater Tonj area in Warrap, and areas that had previously benefitted from relative calm, such as Tambura county, Western Equatoria. The flooding of the Nile River and its tributaries have also affected an estimated 760,000 people, many of whom have experienced multiple years of flooding or concurrent conflict and flood shocks. In addition to preventing normal harvest activities and trade, these events have frequently disrupted or suspended humanitarian access, and have ultimately reduced household access to food.

While national survey data on food insecurity in 2021 is not yet available, past rounds of survey data and current ground information suggest that most of the population is likely experiencing insufficient dietary quantity indicative of Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes, as well as poor dietary quality (Figure 1). At the start of the main harvest in October, hundreds of thousands of people face obstacles to harvesting crops, trading livestock, and engaging in other livelihood activities due to violence or floodwaters that have caused displacement and restricted normal population movement. In addition, millions of people face systemic challenges to rebuilding their livelihoods and regaining their capacity to cope with idiosyncratic shocks, including but not limited to inadequate market infrastructure, barriers to expanding beyond subsistence agriculture, and the low availability of health services. As recent livelihood losses and systemic drivers will most likely impede improvement in food security during the harvest, severe outcomes are expected through May 2022.

In areas with large populations in Emergency (IPC Phase 4), there is a credible, alternative scenario in which Famine (IPC Phase 5) could occur. While it is not the most likely scenario, it is possible that food security conditions could rapidly deteriorate, given the potential for new shocks to isolate households from food sources, as occurred in central Unity in 2017, Greater Baggari in 2018, and Pibor in 2020. In such a scenario, past events demonstrate households would face a substantial and prolonged disruption to their main food sources, leaving them to rely primarily on wild foods. The areas of highest concern include Pibor, the greater Tonj area in Warrap, southern Unity, northern Jonglei, Tambura in Western Equatoria, and parts of Upper Nile. In these areas, the scale of ongoing shocks and available evidence strongly suggest a very high share of the population are currently or will likely face Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes from October 2021 to May 2022. In some cases, past trends and current shocks suggest households are likely to have extreme food consumption gaps indicative of Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5), though their precise location is difficult to confirm without further data.

After the [declaration of Famine Likely \(IPC Phase 5\) in Pibor](#) and the assessment that tens of thousands of people were in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) in five other counties in late 2020, the scale-up of food, health, and nutrition assistance to these areas played a critical role in alleviating extreme outcomes. In Pibor, specifically, evidence suggests humanitarian efforts combined with relative peace and relatively lower flood extent have driven improvement to Emergency (IPC Phase 4) and prevented Famine (IPC Phase 5) from continuing. Many households are benefitting from a slight recovery in crop production and market functioning, as well as freedom of movement to engage in fishing, hunting, and gathering. These improvements notwithstanding, concern remains that the worst-off households in inaccessible and insecure areas of Pibor are likely in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5). Ultimately, an end to conflict and sustained food, health, nutrition, and livelihoods assistance to rebuild livelihoods, resilience, and coping capacity are required to reduce the risk of Famine (IPC Phase 5) in South Sudan.

Figure 1. Trend in the percent of the South Sudanese population reporting a poor or borderline Food Consumption Score (FCS) and trend in the national average FCS, October 2011 – October 2020



Source: Food Security and Nutrition Monitoring System data

NATIONAL OVERVIEW

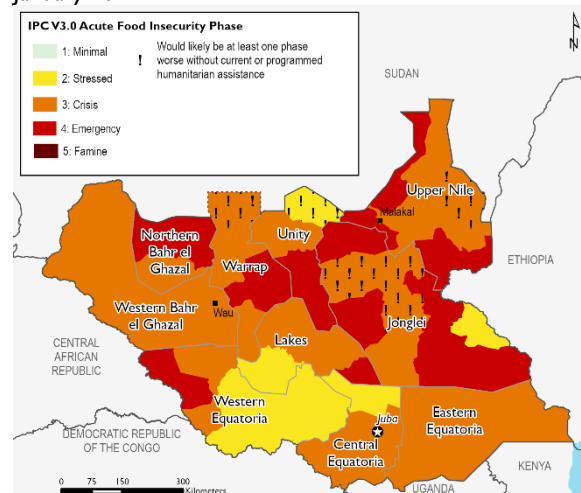
Current Situation

Conflict and displacement: Amid slow implementation of the 2018 peace deal in South Sudan, conflict and insecurity continue to threaten lives, impede crop and livestock production, and significantly disrupt trade, market functioning, and humanitarian operations. Conflict and insecurity are also among the main drivers of high internal displacement, which amounted to 1.71 million people in August, according to OCHA. The third quarter of 2021 was more violent and deadly than the same period of 2020, reflected by a five percent increase in conflict incidents and a 20 percent increase in confirmed fatalities, according to the Armed Conflict Location and Event Data Project (ACLED).² Typically, the July-September period ushers in a general decrease in conflict events as it coincides with the wettest months of the main rainfall season. However, this year saw an increase in conflict in Upper Nile, Western Equatoria, Central Equatoria, and Eastern Equatoria alongside sporadic incidents in Jonglei, Warrap, and Lakes (Figure 2). In Upper Nile, the increase in conflict is namely driven by battles between rival factions of the SPLM/A-IO in Upper Nile. Elsewhere, clashes are primarily between irregular armed groups and labeled inter-communal, though these incidents may also at times be politicized and backed by national-level elites. Greater Equatoria also witnessed high levels of armed ambushes along the Juba-Nimule road – attributed to the South Sudan Opposition Alliance – and clashes between military forces and irregular groups in Tambura county.

Tonj East and Tonj North of Warrap remain among the conflict-affected areas of highest concern for severe food insecurity, despite a relative decline in conflict incidents during the rainy season. According to ACLED's conflict analysis, ongoing violence between ethnic groups – namely the Rek and Luachjang Dinka – is entangled with the political interests of national-level military elites, making the situation complex. Recurrent attacks in 2020 and 2021 have significantly eroded the livelihoods and coping capacity of most civilians, especially in Tonj East. For instance, a REACH assessment conducted in September 2021 reported insecurity prevented many households from cultivating, altered livestock migration patterns, restricted household movement in search of other food and income sources, and constrained trade flows. Despite increased food assistance in 2021 compared to 2020, violence also reportedly prevented households in remote areas from traveling to distribution points or accessing their crop fields. Conflict has persisted through mid-October, disrupting access to main season harvest activities, driving Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes in these counties. Furthermore, the presence of armed, local youth patrols in some areas (Ananatak and greater Marial Lou payams) suggests they may block commercial and humanitarian movements in and out of the key trading center of Romic in the near term.

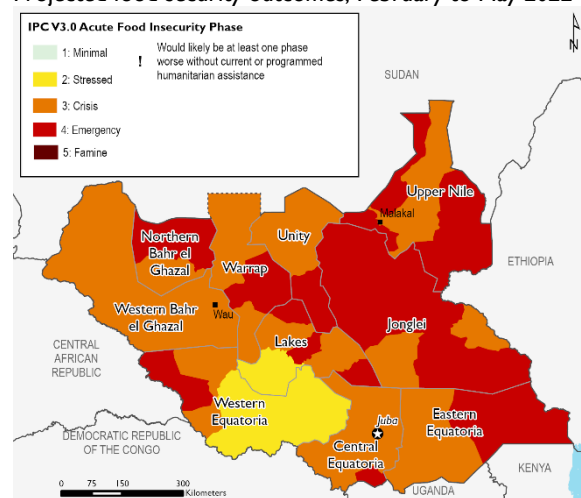
Meanwhile, conflict in Tambura county of Western Equatoria has driven sharp deterioration in food security from Stressed (IPC Phase 2) to Crisis! (IPC Phase 3!) in an area that is typically considered part of South Sudan's "bread basket." Violence between rival armed forces has displaced around 80,000 people (70 percent of the county population). Available interagency assessments indicate over 20 percent of the displaced fled to relatively safer locations within Tambura, while

Projected food security outcomes, October 2021 to January 2022



Source: FEWS NET

Projected food security outcomes, February to May 2022



Source: FEWS NET

FEWS NET classification is IPC-compatible. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners.

² The comparison is based on confirmed, recorded deaths; however, researchers at ACLED observe that fatalities in 2020 likely underestimated the lethality of violence in Jonglei due to access constraints that limited the ability to confirm and record deaths.

the rest fled to neighboring Ezo, Yambio, Nagero, Wau, and Nzara counties. According to a [September 2021 REACH assessment](#), households that were unable to leave southern Tambura face the threat of attacks and forced recruitment. Meanwhile, displaced households had to abandon both their food stocks and standing crops. Moreover, persistent fighting compelled humanitarian responders to evacuate Tambura in mid-October, suspending biometric registration and food assistance delivery to the displaced. Despite directives from the South Sudan Joint Defense Board for SPLM/A-IO forces to stand down, there remains high concern that conflict will continue and spread to Ezo, Nagero, and potentially Wau.

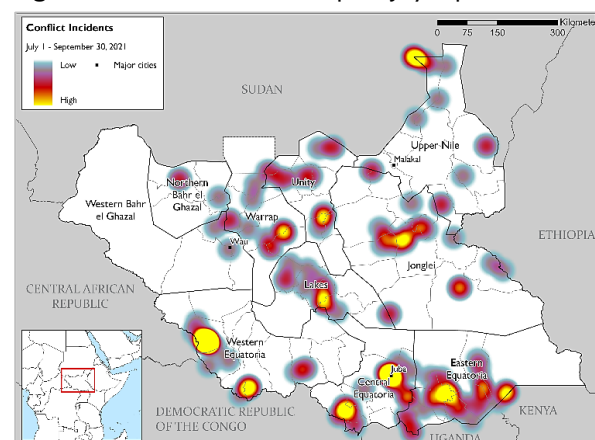
Another area of increasing concern is the Upper Nile-Jonglei border region, where acute food insecurity has been severe since the late 2019 floods and is now exacerbated by concurrent conflict and flood shocks. In this region, the latest uptick in conflict is primarily linked to divisions between rival SPLM/A-IO factions but also has inter-communal characteristics. Although the intensity of SPLM/A-IO conflict incidents is highest in the lowly populated Magenis area of northern Manyo, sporadic events have also occurred in parts of Longochuk, Uror, and the Sobat River corridor along the Upper Nile-Jonglei border. Clashes between inter-communal groups linked to pro-Gatwech and pro-Machar forces have also affected Canal/Pigi and Luakpiny/Nasir. Many households in these areas already lost their main season crops and some livestock due to the ongoing 2021 floods, and insecurity is simultaneously interfering with their ability to harvest surviving crops, trade livestock, or access markets. Moreover, insecurity in Pieri *payam* of Uror led to the suspension of food distribution while humanitarians temporarily evacuated. In addition to the above areas, tensions are reportedly high in Akobo and Nyirol and it is possible that insecurity will increase in the near term and disrupt food assistance delivery in these areas.

Meanwhile, in Mayendit of Unity, tensions between the SPLM/A-IO and SPLM-IG forces over local-level administration appointments have led to armed clashes between SPLM-IG forces and youths loyal to the SPLM/A-IO in late September. If tensions are not contained, further violence in Mayendit could escalate, worsening the already extreme food insecurity compounded by severe floods. Finally, in Pibor, the relocation of WFP – who are affected by an ultimatum issued by Murle youths on October 4 giving NGOs 72 hours to leave – has temporarily suspended delivery of food assistance. The timing of this event overlaps with the harvest, a period in which previously-provided food assistance distribution plans indicated a three-month scale-down in food assistance in Pibor; as such, these concerning developments have yet to change the near-term scenario in Pibor, since negotiations to resume assistance are underway.

Rainfall performance and flooding: For the third consecutive year, the end of the main June to September rainfall season has extended into October and has been marked by widespread, severe flooding in river basins and low-lying areas. Heavy rainfall in late September and October led to an increase in flood extent in the northern Sudd Wetlands and areas of the Lol and Sobat-Akobo River catchments, especially in Unity, Jonglei, and Upper Nile states (Figure 3). Additionally, heavy rainfall led to flooding in parts of Western and Central Equatoria, Lakes, Warrap, and Western Bahr El Ghazal. Despite a decline in rainfall intensity to average levels in October in some areas, like Northern Bahr el Ghazal and Warrap, the rain has fallen on already-high river water levels and is likely to maintain high flood extent into the next month.

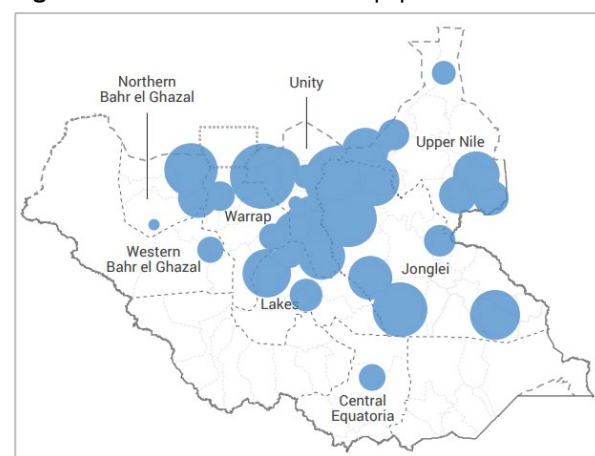
According to OCHA's most recent update for October 2021, floods have affected an estimated 760,000 people in 8 of South Sudan's 10 states. Based on the flood extent and the size of the flood-affected population, the worst-affected areas include southern and northwestern Unity, northwestern Jonglei, and parts of Northern and Western Bahr el Ghazal. To date, the national flood-affected population is only five percent lower than 2020 (800,000) and roughly 16 percent lower than 2019

Figure 2. Conflict events in hotspots, July-September 2021



Source: data from *Armed Conflict Location and Event Data Project*

Figure 3. Location of flood-affected population, Oct. 2021



Source: OCHA

(908,000). Additionally, the northward shift in flood-affected areas between 2020 and 2021 is noteworthy, leading to more severe flood impacts in Unity, northern Jonglei, Northern Bahr el Ghazal, and northern Warrap in 2021 than 2020.

In line with FEWS NET's earlier projections, the floods have significantly worsened food security conditions at the start of the harvest period. Very wet conditions are likely to persist at least until the full onset of the dry season in December. Key informants

and 15 inter-agency rapid assessments (IRNA) report significant displacement of people and livestock to higher grounds, significant to near-total crop losses, and submerged or cut-off markets and trade routes. In some cases, such as in the Upper Nile-Jonglei border region and greater Tonj of Warrap, there is high concern that concurrent conflict incidents may further restrict population movements and strand households, which makes activities such as fishing, hunting, and gathering more difficult and dangerous. The inundation of health facilities and contamination of water sources

also means many communities are unable to access basic services, which past trends show is likely driving an increase in disease incidence, morbidity, and acute malnutrition levels. While the government of South Sudan has announced the allocation of 10 million USD for its national flood response, the scale of need is expected to outpace these resources. Currently, humanitarian food assistance delivery is ongoing with significant funding and logistic constraints.

Main season crop production: Available field information suggests national crop production prospects for the 2021 main season are similar to better than 2020 and the five-year average, but well below pre-conflict levels. Additionally, there are significant variations in harvest prospects between states due to varying livelihood contexts and conflict and flood shocks, resulting in a large national cereal deficit. As such, state-level harvests in 2021 will vary, with the largest deficits expected in flood-affected areas of Jonglei, Unity, Northern Bahr el Ghazal, Upper Nile, and Warrap. As rainfall subsides, the risk of further crop losses depends on the slow pace of receding floodwaters and the lack of dry ground on which to dry harvested crops. Despite these losses, the harvest of groundnut and short-maturing sorghum in parts of Northern Bahr el Ghazal, Lakes, and Western Bahr el Ghazal and the green harvest of maize in Pibor and Akobo East of Jonglei are contributing to household food availability. Meanwhile, long-cycle sorghum that survived floods in high-ground areas of Unity, Tonj South of Warrap, Fashoda of Upper Nile, and Greater Rumbek and Greater Yirol in Lakes is expected to be harvested in late October.

In bimodal Greater Equatoria, drying and harvesting of short-cycle crops are underway in October, increasing the availability of sorghum, maize, and groundnuts, and second-season, long-maturing sorghum is in the late vegetative stage and will be harvested in late December or January. Similarly, the ratoon crops in greater Kapoeta are also at vegetative/flowering stage and second season crops are at vegetative to flowering stages in Magwi, southern Torit, mountainous areas of Ikwoto and Budi County of Eastern Equatoria state; Yei, Morobo, Lainya county of Central Equatoria State; Pochalla county of Jonglei; and all counties of Western Equatoria, with the exception of Mvolo, and Tambura are expected to be harvested in late December to early January.

Livestock production: Nationally, livestock production is mixed given the negative impacts of floods and conflict on livestock migration and productivity. Normally, livestock are typically nearer homesteads and in good condition during the rainy season, but livestock body conditions currently range from good to poor across the pastoral and agropastoral livelihoods zones given varying levels of access to pastures and water. Field assessments have confirmed atypical movement from flood-affected areas to higher grounds, including massive livestock displacement in Unity; Jonglei; Upper Nile; Aweil South of Northern Bahr el Ghazal; and Gogrial East, Gogrial West, and Greater Tonj of Warrap. Over 20 IRNA conducted in flood-affected counties of Greater Upper Nile and Greater Bahr el Ghazal between July and September have confirmed livestock deaths linked to lack of pastures and standing floodwaters. Based on these reports, the magnitude of livestock deaths in 2021 is greatest in Mayendit, Leer, and Panyijiar of Unity; and Ayod, Fangak, and Canal/Pigi of Jonglei. Although vegetation conditions are worse in 2021 (Figure 4), it is estimated livestock deaths were greater in 2020, when more livestock were lost as a direct result of floods. The compounding impact of livestock losses in both years, and lower access to milk from poor body conditions, is significantly limiting household food access.

Macroeconomic conditions: Following an estimated economic contraction of 5.4 percent in FY2020/2021, macroeconomic conditions have improved modestly with the most recent efforts by the government of South Sudan to spur the economy

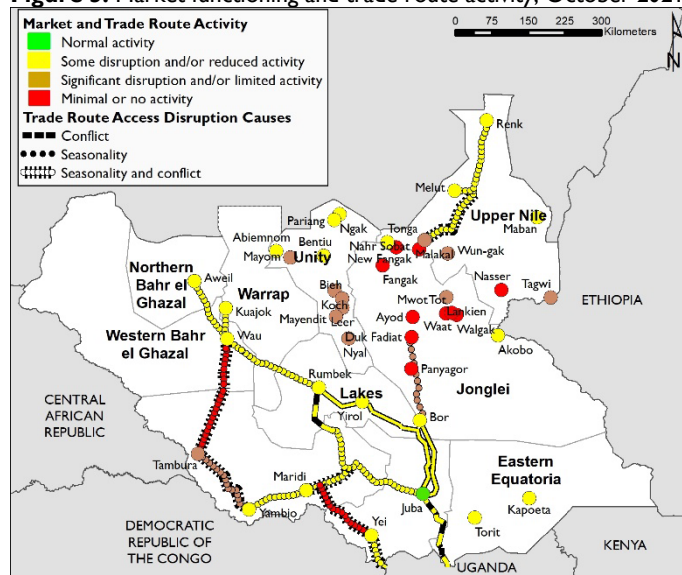
Figure 4. Vegetation conditions shown as a percent of the 2003-2017 median based on eMODIS NDVI, October 1-10 2021



Source: USGS

by securing loans from international financial institutions. The most recent cash injection includes a loan totaling 334 million USD from the International Monetary Fund (IMF) in late August in efforts to boost the country's foreign exchange reserves, offset the economic shocks caused by the COVID-19, and support ongoing macroeconomic and financial management reforms. Multiple disbursements from IMF mechanisms since late 2020, underpinned by strengthening global oil prices that boosted oil revenue, have increased the availability of hard currency, facilitated the modest stabilization of the exchange rate, driven a decline in inflation, and increased the government's ability to reduce salary arrears substantially. As observed by the World Bank, the annual inflation rate fell from a peak of nearly 70 percent in January to 18 percent by June 2021. A significant driver of inflation was the unification of the official and parallel exchange rates, which exhibited a difference of nearly 250 percent in early 2021 that has now been effectively eliminated.

Figure 5. Market functioning and trade route activity, October 2021



Source: FEWS NET

These macroeconomic reforms have had a direct impact on food security by increasing the capacity of traders to finance imports, facilitating a decline in staple food prices in most markets. However, many economic challenges persist due to the protracted years of conflict, the COVID-19 pandemic, and the slow recovery in crude oil production and oil- and non-revenue collection and management. Income-earning opportunities remain limited, and, according to the World Bank, the poverty rate rose to an estimated 79 percent in FY 2020/2021.

Markets and trade functioning: Markets within the state capitals remain functional, but functionality and trade flows – measured in terms of the number of traders and levels of supply or demand relative to normal – varies widely across the counties, with the level of disruptions linked to conflict or floods. Market functionality and trade flows are significantly disrupted in Jonglei, Unity, and Upper Nile and along the Yei-Maridi road in Central and Yambio-Tambura to Nagero of Western Equatoria to Wau of Western Equatoria (Figure 5) due to renewed conflict, insecurity, or floods. In Greater Upper Nile, market and trade functioning has been significantly constrained by floods, and led to limited or no cereals in Ayod, Fangak of Jonglei; Panyagor of Twic East, and Motot of Uror as a result. Furthermore, field assessments further indicate that households have low or limited physical access to markets due to the impassability of roads.

Meanwhile, cross-border trade from Uganda and Sudan to South Sudan continues to flow though with periodic disruptions linked to road ambushes/insecurity or floods. From late August to mid-September, cross-border trade flows from Uganda to South Sudan were temporarily halted for two weeks due to long-distance truck drivers' strikes in response to escalation of road ambushes in mid-August. As a result of this protest, as well as lower-than-average supplies in Uganda given their below-average first season harvest, cross-border trade flows through Nimule border crossing declined. Commercial truck drivers resumed transport in the first week of September with military escorts following talks between South Sudanese and Ugandan authorities, and this drove improvement in cross-border trade flows via Nimule by late September. Based on FEWS NET's analysis of monthly cross-border trade data from September 2021, the import volume of sorghum grain from Uganda to South Sudan was 35 percent higher than recorded in August 2021 but, based on [FEWS NET's quarterly cross-border trade monitoring data](#), the importation of sorghum during the July to September third quarter was overall 18 percent lower than the previous quarter. Still, imports were 574 percent above last year and 507 percent above the five-year average, likely linked to the increased availability of hard currency.

Staple food prices and terms of trade: Based on monthly price monitoring data available in [CLiMIS](#) for September, the retail price of a *malwa* (3.5 kg) of white sorghum was 14 to 25 percent lower than observed in August 2021 in Wau and Aweil Centre and remained stable in Juba and Rumbek Centre due to availability of harvests, food aid, and increased imports from Sudan and Uganda (Figure 6). Compared to September of last year, the sorghum price was still 70 percent higher in Juba, while ranging from 28 to 62 percent lower in Aweil Centre, Wau, and Rumbek Centre. However, while the price was similar to the five-year average in Rumbek Centre, prices remained generally 26 to 193 percent above the five-year average in Wau, Aweil, and Juba due to high import inflation, local exchange rate variations, and seasonal feeder road deterioration. In Aweil,

the price was 57 percent below the five-year average, likely due to better access to hard currency for food imports and high supplies from both Sudan and Uganda.

The terms of trade, measured by the amount of sorghum that could be purchased with a day's wage rate, continued to improve in Aweil from 34 to 47 kgs per day's wage, remain stable (15 kgs per day's wage) in Wau, and reduced further in Juba from 5 to 4 kgs per day's wage between August and September.

Humanitarian food assistance: Humanitarian food assistance continues to be a primary source of food in many poor households and plays a significant role in mitigating the severity of acute food insecurity in many counties, including flood- and conflict-affected areas. It is FEWS NET's assessment that the total population that currently needs food assistance is within the range of 7-8 million. Despite acute logistic, flood, and security challenges, WFP reached 2.57 million people with food

assistance in August, which is 58 percent more people than reached in July. In September, WFP's distribution report confirms 1.88 million people received food assistance. In addition, WFP reported plans to reach over 800,000 people with its Safety Net and Resilience portfolio and 732,000 beneficiaries with nutrition commodities. Based on the monthly average between July and September, humanitarian food assistance to priority counties – including those previously assessed to have households in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) and those severely affected by floods in 2020 – has been distributed to under 10 percent of the population in Duk and Twic East; between 10 and 20 percent of the population in Akobo and Ayod; and over 20 percent of the population in Pibor, Aweil South, Bor South, Tonj South, Tonj East, and Tonj North." WFP continues to encounter several challenges, including road access constraints due to floods, conflicts and insecurity, funding shortages, and the high costs associated with river and air operations, which have delayed, suspended, or disrupted deliveries in various counties.

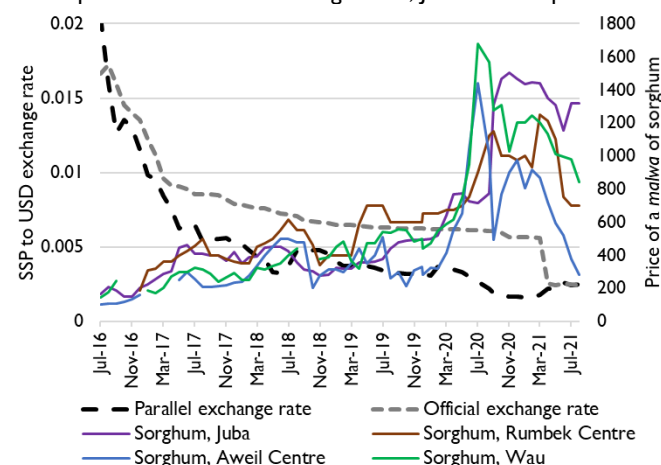
Current outcomes

Nationally, Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or worse outcomes are widespread at the start of the harvesting period in October given the continuation of multiple compounding shocks, including conflict, insecurity, and floods. As such, households face moderate to large food consumption gaps, indicative of Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes. Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes are likely present in 21 counties, primarily concentrated in Jonglei, Unity, Northern Bahr el Ghazal, Warrap, and Upper Nile. In these areas, more severe outcomes are mainly linked to the devastation of crops and livestock and disruption to trade flows and market functioning by severe floods from July to October, the increase in conflict along the Upper Nile-Jonglei border region since July, and the resumption of inter-communal conflicts and violence in early October. In Tambura, the high level of population displacement, abandonment of the first season harvest, and disruption to main season planting drove sharp deterioration in outcomes from Stressed (IPC Phase 2) to Crisis! (IPC Phase 3!) in October.

Of greatest concern are counties that were worst-affected by floods since July, where the population faces substantial disruption in their access to food. These counties include Leer, Mayendit, Panyijiar, Mayom counties of Unity; Fangak, Canal/Pigi, and Ayod counties of Jonglei; Aweil South, Aweil East, Aweil North, and Aweil West of Northern Bahr el Ghazal; and Gogrial West, Gogrial East, Tonj North, and Tonj East of Warrap. Key informant and other IRNA/field assessments report extensive crop and livestock losses, very limited to no trade flows and market functioning, and restricted humanitarian access due to the floods. Some of these areas simultaneously face concurrent threats from conflict. Given flood-and conflict-related disruptions to typical food and income sources and massive displacement, many households face large food consumption gaps with very low coping capacity. Based on the severity of ongoing shocks as well as past trends, it is further likely that some households in Fangak, Ayod, and Canal/Pigi of Jonglei and Mayendit, Leer, and Panyijiar of Unity who lost their entire crops or livestock and have little to no access to food assistance or markets are in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5).

Pibor remains the area of highest concern in South Sudan. Emergency (IPC Phase 4) is most likely present at the start of the harvest in Pibor, due to the scale-up in food, nutrition, and health assistance and lower levels of conflict from March to September. These conditions enabled households to increase the area planted, resulting in a relatively better crop harvest

Figure 6. Price of a malwa (3.5 kg) of white sorghum compared to the parallel and official exchange rates, Jul. 2016 – Sep. 2021



Source: data from South Sudan Crop and Livestock Market Information System

in September 2021, and permitted humanitarian access to reach more of the worst-affected households in Pibor. Cumulatively, these developments drove some improvement from Famine Likely (IPC Phase 5) in late 2020 to Emergency (IPC Phase 4) by October. Nevertheless, humanitarian access to inaccessible and/or insecure areas remains extremely challenging to date. The youth from Greater Pibor Administrative Area (GPAA) issued an ultimatum on October 4th to humanitarian organizations operating in Greater Pibor to evacuate all the relocatable staff from the area within 72 hours, mainly linked to demands to hire local staff. Later, a group of youth attacked humanitarian staff preparing a food distribution in Gumuruk of Pibor. This has led to the suspension of the delivery of humanitarian assistance, and the resumption will be contingent on negotiations for local employment quotas. Currently, key health and nutrition services remain operational. **More information is available on pages 11-12 of this report.**

Finally, in parts of the Equatorias and parts of Lakes and Jonglei where relative calm and conducive rainfall enabled this year's harvests to perform slightly better than last year and facilitate a higher level of household movement and market access, Stressed (IPC Phase 2) outcomes are likely.

Assumptions

The most likely scenario from October 2021 to May 2022 is based on the following national-level assumptions:

- Conflict events and insecurity are likely to slow the implementation of key elements of the peace deal, such as the graduation of a unified national security force. In Upper Nile, political violence between General Simon Gatwech Dual's and Vice President Riek Machar's SPLM/A-IO factions will continue and may spread to other counties outside of Manyo due to a high likelihood for further defections within SPLA M/-IO forces. In the Equatorias, armed ambushes along the Juba-Nimule road, and attacks by non-state armed groups engaging violently with the SPLM over inter-communal grievances in Tambura county, will likely resume as floods recede and increase during the dry season from January onward, reaching higher levels than those reported during the first five months of 2021. Intercommunal violence in Warrap, Lakes, and Jonglei states is likely to resume as the floods recede and increase during the dry season from January onward, reaching similar levels as those reported during the same period in 2021.
- Based on recent and anticipated floods and conflict, the internally displaced population is expected to rise compared to the last official IOM DTM estimate of 1.7 million. Past trends show that while many flood-displaced people will return home after floodwaters recede, a significant number will likely remain in IDP camps or host communities. Large-scale displacement due to conflict is also likely to continue, exemplified by the displacement of more than 80,000 people in Tambura of Western Equatoria since June. Meanwhile, spontaneous refugee returns are likely to be similar to lower than 2020 due to these shocks and persistently poor macroeconomic conditions.
- Rainfall began to subside in South Sudan in the second half of October and is forecast to further subside in November, which is expected to gradually permit floodwaters to recede between November and December. However, based on the level of flooding and soil saturation, wetland extent is likely to remain higher than normal into the 2021/2022 dry season, including in Sudd Wetland and areas of Jonglei and Unity and parts of Northern Bahr el Ghazal and Upper Nile.
- Based on NOAA and USGS analysis of historical analog years with similar climatic conditions, the March to May 2022 first rainfall season in southern and western bimodal areas of South Sudan is most likely to be average.
- The 2021 main season harvest, which starts in September/October and continues through December, is expected to be similar to slightly better than 2020 and the five-year average, but well below pre-conflict levels. This projection is based on historical Crop and Food Security Assessment Mission data, a reported increase in planted area in some unimodal areas of Greater Upper Nile and Greater Bahr el Ghazal, seasonal rainfall performance, but significant pre- or post-harvest crop losses in areas affected by heavy rain and floods (Jonglei, Unity, Northern Bahr el Ghazal, and Upper Nile), dry spells (Eastern Equatoria), or conflict (Jonglei, Upper Nile, Warrap, Lakes, and Greater Equatoria). Although the harvest will increase food availability and access across the country through at least February, significant variations are likely between and within counties due to the local impacts of conflict or floods on crop production.
- Based on recent and anticipated conflict and flood shocks, livestock holdings and productivity are expected to remain significantly below normal and may further decline in Jonglei, Unity, and Upper Nile, as well as parts of Warrap and Lakes. Milk availability will vary between counties and households depending on livestock holdings, pasture availability, and disease incidence; however, production will remain high through November/December and decline through March/April in accordance with seasonal water and pasture availability and wet/dry season grazing patterns.
- The seasonal availability of fish, game, and wild fruits and vegetables typically peaks between October and February as

floodwaters recede and then declines through March/April. However, some communities in more severe conflict- and flood-affected areas in Jonglei, Unity, Northern Bahr el Ghazal, Upper Nile, Warrap, and Lakes will likely face periodic access restrictions to gathering, fishing, and hunting.

- Economic growth projections by the [African Development Bank \(AfDB\)](#) and [The World Bank](#) indicate South Sudan's economy will likely grow by 2.5 to 2.6 percent in FY2021/2022. Economic activity will remain constrained by oil production challenges, subnational conflict and insecurity, and the COVID-19 pandemic. However, a partial economic recovery will be supported by higher global oil prices; the easing of cross-border movement restrictions; relative calm in security conditions in some counties; and public financial management reforms and international financing related to IMF disbursements under [the Rapid Credit Facility](#) (225 million USD in Nov. 2020 and Mar. 2021) and an IMF [Special Drawings Rights allocation](#) (334 million USD in Aug. 2021). The AfDB projects these drivers will most likely push inflation down to 23.3 percent in 2021 compared to 31.1 percent in 2020, which will better facilitate food and non-food imports.
- Food commodity imports are expected to rise, facilitated by the unification of the exchange rate, lower inflation, and the reopening of several border crossing posts with Sudan. However, periodic disruptions to trade flows due to attacks along the routes from Uganda to Juba remain likely despite enhanced security escorts. Meanwhile, domestic trade flows between market hubs (e.g., Juba and Wau) and rural markets will likely remain below normal, as will overall market functioning. On the one hand, trade will gradually increase as floodwaters slowly recede after October. On the other hand, trade will subsequently be affected by an anticipated uptick in conflict, insecurity, and banditry during the dry season from January to April/May. As a result, local market supply shortages are likely to periodically occur in conflict- and flood-affected areas of Greater Upper Nile and Greater Bahr el Ghazal. Low household purchasing power and demand in these areas can also reinforce supply shortages, as traders are discouraged from investing in supplying them.
- Based on FEWS NET's integrated price projections, the retail price per *malwa* (3.5 kg) of white sorghum is expected to generally decline through the October to December harvest period and remain stable or rise during the January to May post-harvest period in the major markets of Juba, Bor South, Wau, and Aweil. The unit price is expected to range from 12 percent above to 44 percent below the preceding year, driven by seasonal crop production prospects, seasonal variation in domestic trade flows, rising food imports, and lower inflation. However, the unit price is still expected to range from 22 to 177 percent above the five-year averages given persistent macroeconomic constraints, the national cereal deficit, and high import and transportation costs. The unit price is projected to be highest in Juba, ranging between 1,380 and 1,465 SSP, and lowest in Aweil, ranging between 385 and 580 SSP.
- **Wages and terms of trade:** Based on the daily labor wage rate and retail price of sorghum observed since July in the urban centers of Aweil, Wau, and Juba, household purchasing power measured by the amount of sorghum that can be purchased with a day's wage is expected to modestly strengthen between October and May in Aweil and Wau, facilitated by the harvest and partial economic recovery. However, household purchasing power in Juba is expected to remain suppressed due to higher staple food prices and high competition for limited casual labor opportunities.
- **Humanitarian food assistance:** The latest available information from WFP indicates food assistance between October and December plans aim to reach up to 11 percent of the national population, which is revised upward from previous plans to reach six percent of the national population. County-level plans to incorporate the impact of assistance are newly available, though further analysis is required to determine the likely targeting and reach of assistance relative to the need. As such, this outlook incorporates previously available assistance distribution plans and will be updated upon completion of the analysis of newly available distribution plans. Food assistance plans are not yet available for 2022.

Most Likely Food Security Outcomes

Nationally, the significant loss of crops, livestock, and other livelihood assets and widespread population displacement due to recurrent conflict and floods will continue to drive high levels of acute food insecurity during the harvesting and post-harvesting period from October 2021 to January 2022. As most of the country will continue to experience moderate to large food consumption gaps, Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes will likely remain widespread, and 24 counties are expected to be in Emergency (IPC Phase 4). Humanitarian food assistance is likely to mitigate food insecurity outcomes in some parts of Jonglei, Unity, Upper Nile, and Eastern Equatoria to Crisis! (IPC Phase 3!) or Stressed (IPC Phase 2!). In less flood-affected or relatively stable states, food security is expected to improve only marginally, primarily among households who own livestock or have access to functioning markets and have harvested crops. During this period, the increased availability of livestock products (such as milk) and natural food sources (such as fish and wild foods) will be at their annual peaks. However, despite recent gains in exchange rate stabilization and some declines in staple food prices in key reference markets such as

Aweil, Wau, and Bor South, many households are still likely to be unable to purchase adequate food from the markets. Prices remain high overall, and there have been limited gains in income-earning opportunities and purchasing power.

Food insecurity is expected to worsen during the February to May 2022 post-harvest period. Sharp deterioration is likely to occur in severely flood-affected counties, where the harvests will deplete atypically early in January or February, leaving many households with large food consumption gaps. It is also anticipated that residual floodwaters and conflict or insecurity may also periodically disrupt or limit household access to markets, trade of livestock and livestock products, and engagement in fishing, hunting, and gathering. Under these circumstances, Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes will most likely expand to 33 counties during this period, which also overlaps with the start of the lean season.

Throughout the projection period, the areas of highest concern will remain Pibor, northern Jonglei, southern Unity, parts of Upper Nile, Warrap, and Tambura in Western Equatoria due to the likelihood that very high shares of the population are likely to be in Emergency (IPC Phase 4). These areas have experienced the greatest livelihood losses and have the highest level of disruptions to trade and market functioning, and they are likely to continue to face restrictions on population movement and humanitarian access in the medium term due to wide flood extent and/or conflict. Within these areas, some households are likely to experience Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5), though their precise location is difficult to confirm in the absence of household survey data. Based on the severity of recent shocks, however, FEWS NET assesses Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) is most likely to occur in the counties of Pibor; Mayendit, Leer, and Panyijar of Unity; Fangak, Ayod, and Canal/Pigi of Jonglei; and Tonj East and Tonj North of Warrap. **For a detailed outlook on Pibor, please refer to pages 10-11.**

Throughout the projection period, there remains a risk of Famine (IPC Phase 5). While Famine is not the most likely scenario, Famine could occur in a credible alternative scenario in which a shock isolates households from their typical food sources for a prolonged period. This is a credible risk given the high share of the population facing large food consumption gaps and the potential for new shocks to isolate households from food sources.

Events That Could Change the Outlook

Table 1. Possible events over the next eight months that could change the most likely scenario.

Area	Event	Impact on food security outcomes
National	Sustained economic reforms strengthen the enabling environment for trade and stimulate economic activity	An improved enabling environment for trade that leads to a further decline in staple food prices in key reference markets, leading to an increase in the availability of income-earning opportunities and household purchasing power. This is likely to increase household access to food. A decline in the population in Emergency (IPC Phase 4) and Crisis (IPC Phase 3) would be likely.
	Internal divisions with parties to the 2018 peace deal lead to a more significant increase in conflict	A significant increase in conflict would cause displacement, restrict household livelihood activities, significantly disrupt market functioning and trade, and impede humanitarian food assistance delivery, among other impacts. More widespread Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes would be possible, as well as an increase in households in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5). Based on past trends, this scenario could lead to Famine (IPC Phase 5) if conflict prevented households from accessing their main food sources for a prolonged time.
Pibor	Food assistance does not resume by early 2022 and/or there is an increase in conflict	If humanitarians are unable to reach an agreement with the Murle youth to resume food assistance delivery, and if relative calm is maintained, then an increase in the number of households in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) would likely occur. If a resurgence in conflict suspended food and health assistance, caused displacement, and disrupted livelihood and market activities for a prolonged time, then past trends suggest this scenario could lead to Famine (IPC Phase 5) given the already large population in Emergency (IPC Phase 4).
Greater Tonj of Warrap	Adherence to local peace agreement and a decline in conflict	In the event that local youths agree to disarm or adhere to the local peace initiatives, then a return of relative calm to Tonj East and Tonj North would likely permit greater household engagement in livelihood activities, improve trade flows and market functioning, and better facilitate food and non-food assistance delivery to food-insecure households. Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes would be likely during the harvesting and post-harvesting period.
Jonglei-Upper Nile border region	Unwillingness of the parties to reconcile at Khartoum peace talks, leading to spreading conflict	If conflict between SPLM/A-IO factions spreads from the western bank of the Nile in Manyo to the eastern bank, food security conditions in adjacent counties – including Melut, Baliet and Malakal – would likely deteriorate. Impacts would likely include disruption to harvest, trade, and market activities, as well as food assistance delivery. Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes would be expected.

AREAS OF CONCERN

Greater Pibor Administrative Area (Figure 7)

Current Situation

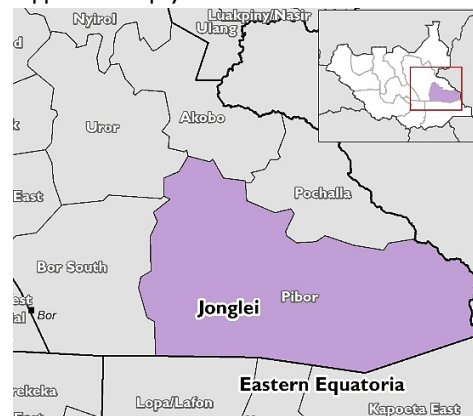
The sustained scale-up of food assistance and basic health and nutrition services since early 2021, supported by low levels of conflict and less severe flood extent during the 2021 crop production season, has likely driven marginal improvement to Emergency (IPC Phase 4) in Pibor. After the assessment of Famine Likely (IPC Phase 5) in late 2020, food assistance delivery scaled up to reach 25-40 percent of the population monthly between February and September (Figure 8). Humanitarian partners also prioritized the establishment of new distribution points in remote areas, including in Lekuangle and Gumuruk. After a March 2021 SMART survey showed extreme hunger and acute malnutrition levels had declined below the Famine (IPC Phase 5) thresholds, information from key informants suggests these efforts, coupled with health and nutrition services, served as a life-saving stopgap during the 2021 lean season and likely led to a decline in the population in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5).

In addition to food assistance, relative calm and a seasonally typical extent of flooding along the Pibor River facilitated a slight recovery in planting, fishing, hunting, and gathering activities, and market functioning during the 2021 rainy season compared to 2020. Security in Pibor has remained relatively stable since mid-May, and unverified, initial reports estimate there are around 35,000 flood-affected people in Pibor town and surrounding villages compared to over 125,000 flood-affected people in 2020. These conditions, coupled with some seed and agricultural input distributions from CRS, Intersos, ACROSS, and others, facilitated an increase in the area planted. Consequently, dry maize and sorghum are currently being harvested, and key informants assess the 2021 harvest is better than 2020. Favorable rainfall and seasonal floods have also facilitated improvement in household access to seasonal fishing areas and traditional grounds for collecting wild fruits and vegetables. Market functioning is still both seasonally and atypically low, but local traders are again operating in Gumuruk and Verteth. Staple foods are reportedly available in the market despite the seasonal flooding of the Juba-Bor-Pibor Road. Although floodwaters temporarily submerged shops in the Pibor Town area and displaced market vendors to higher grounds, key informants report the water is already subsiding.

Despite these noteworthy improvements, food and income sources remain inadequate due to the severity of past shocks and continue to drive Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes with households in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5). Most significantly, the large-scale livestock losses that occurred over the course of the national and subnational conflicts will take multiple years to recover in the absence of significant livelihood interventions. Current estimates of livestock ownership are not yet available but were estimated in the range of 40 percent in March compared to nearly 80 percent in mid-2019. Given the significant contribution of livestock production to traditional food and income sources in this agropastoral area, and limited alternative options to provide a substitute, other food and income sources are inadequate to cover the food consumption gap. There are initial signs of recovery, though, including the return of cattle owners to wet season grazing areas near homesteads, goat restocking implemented by NGOs, and reports that milk is available for purchase at the market.

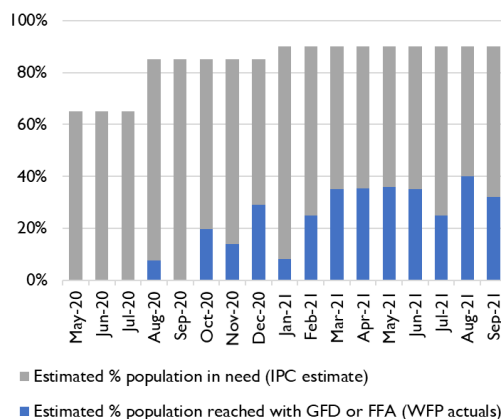
In addition, the large scale of need in Pibor compared to the scale of assistance delivery (Figure 8) suggests that many households in need of food assistance did not receive it. This is not only due to funding constraints but also difficult humanitarian access to remote areas – such as parts of Gumuruk and Gogolthin *payams* – that are largely inaccessible due to impassable roads and persistent insecurity that restrict the reach of humanitarian deliveries. Available information from key informants suggests households in distant, remote areas are likely intermittently experiencing large to extreme food

Figure 7. Area of concern reference map: Pibor, mapped at the payam level



Source: FEWS NET

Figure 8. Estimated share of the Pibor population that received food assistance compared to the share that needs food assistance, May 2020 – September 2021



Source: data from South Sudan IPC and WFP distribution reports

consumption gaps due to a lack of resources to produce sufficient food and limited mobility to seek alternative food and income sources. These households face difficulty traveling long distances through flooded or insecure areas to access food distribution sites, which are typically set up in *payam* headquarters. WFP has sought to address this constraint through the set-up of new distribution points in the remote areas of Lokoromach in Lekuangle and Molokthoch in Gumuruk, but gaps in coverage still exist due to insufficient resources. Such logistical constraints are also regularly exacerbated by attacks on humanitarian staff, recently reported in Gumuruk. Households in remote areas also have little to no access to health and nutrition services, clean water, and sanitation, which is likely contributing to elevated levels of acute malnutrition.

In this context, there is a very high concern for the suspension of at least six humanitarian organizations' operations in October due to ongoing negotiations with the Murle youth of Pibor to meet an ultimatum for local hire quotas. The impasse has directly affected humanitarian food assistance delivery, and WFP reports it has suspended food distribution in six locations, including Lekuangle, Gumuruk, Verteth, Lokoromach, and Molokthoch. However, some NGOs such as MedAir remain operational, and available information indicates health and nutrition service provision is less directly affected due to existing local hire practices. Additionally, ground conditions appear to remain relatively calm, as WFP staff were still able to conduct a site visit in Lekuangle and Verteth to conduct stock counts of warehouse commodities following the formal suspension of operations. Currently, FEWS NET assesses that the harvest availability, seasonal peak in wild food availability, the continuation of health and nutrition services, and the completion of food assistance deliveries to 73,941 people in Lekuangle, Gumuruk, and Labrab in September have served to sustain Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes in October.

Assumptions

In addition to the national assumptions on pages 8-9, the most likely outcomes in Pibor are based on these assumptions:

- This scenario assumes that WFP and partners will reach an agreement with the Murle youth that enables the resumption of humanitarian food assistance deliveries by air or road no later than January 2022. While planned, county-level targets for food assistance in 2022 are not yet available to FEWS NET, this scenario also assumes humanitarian food assistance will reach at least 25 percent of the population in Pibor at a minimum based on current funding and targeting priorities.
- Based on past trends, violence in Pibor is likely to rise during the dry season from January onward. Sporadic attacks and insecurity are expected to periodically disrupt livelihood activities, cause temporary displacement, and disrupt humanitarian operations. The level of conflict is expected to be similar to the same period of 2021.
- Based on the expectation that levels of conflict will remain similar to 2021, trade flows and market functioning are expected to relatively increase but at below normal levels due to conflict during the dry season.

Most Likely Food Security Outcomes

Under the scenario that food assistance delivery does not resume until January, FEWS NET assesses that the availability of harvest stocks, peak seasonal availability of fish and wild foods, improved market functioning and trade during the dry season, and the provision of health and nutrition services will likely be minimally adequate to sustain Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes through December. Milk and livestock products will be seasonally available, but a large share of the population will have low access to these food sources due to the loss of their livestock holdings. Given the previous contribution of livestock production to household food and income, the limited expansion of subsistence agriculture, and few alternative income sources, a large share of the population will likely still have large food consumption gaps during the harvest period. Some of the worst-off households in remote areas will likely experience extreme food gaps indicative of Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5).

The resumption of humanitarian food assistance by January is critical to stabilizing food security conditions in Pibor during the pastoral lean season. From January to May, the availability of household food stocks is expected to become exhausted, leaving people predominantly reliant on hunting and gathering or bartering/purchasing food from local markets. The delivery of food assistance, coupled with health and nutrition interventions, is projected to both mitigate the size of the population with extreme food consumption gaps and mitigate the severity of acute malnutrition levels. Under this scenario, Emergency (IPC Phase 4) with some households in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) will most likely be sustained.

While not the most likely scenario, an increase in the population in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) is possible in an alternative scenario where humanitarians are unable to resume food assistance deliveries to Pibor. However, if this event occurs, it is expected that relative calm would continue to facilitate normal population movement in search of food sources, and NGO providers of health and nutrition services would remain operational. Contingent on these two other factors, acute malnutrition and mortality levels would likely not deteriorate above the Famine (IPC Phase 5) thresholds.

Unity state: Leer, Mayendit, Mayom, and Panyijiar counties (SS07: Western Floodplain livelihood zone; SS08: Nile Basin Fishing and Agropastoral livelihood zone; SS09: Northwestern Nile Basin Cattle and Maize livelihood zone) (Figure 9)

Current Situation

Unity state is one of the areas most affected by the 2021 floods, with the most extensive flooding occurring in Leer, Mayendit, Mayom, and Panyijiar counties. Multiple, compounding weather, conflict, and economic shocks since 2013 had already weakened the viability of local livelihoods, eroded household coping capacity, and increased poverty levels, especially in Leer and Mayendit, where Famine (IPC Phase 5) was declared in 2017. Findings from a [Joint Food Security and Livelihood assessment conducted by REACH and WFP](#) in Mayendit and Leer in June 2021 found that the poor and very poor wealth groups likely compose 30 and 50 percent of the population in Mayendit and Leer, respectively. Additionally, there has been a significant shift in power dynamics from traditional community leaders to armed youth groups, which has diminished the role of traditional community coping mechanisms such as resource-sharing and the chiefs' courts system. Given high household vulnerability to new hazards, the severity of the ongoing floods has driven rapid deterioration in food insecurity.

Based on inter-agency flood assessments conducted in August 2021, at least 20-45 percent of the population in Leer, Mayendit, Mayom, and Panyijiar counties have been affected by the 2021 floods.

Two consecutive years of heavy rainfall in 2020 and 2019 had already increased Nile River water levels and expanded local wetland extent to record-high levels, and the 2021 June to September main rainfall season brought a total of 500-750 mm of rainfall to the area. The floods have caused extensive damage to homes and basic services (e.g., health and nutrition facilities), contaminated water sources, submerged markets, and washed out the roads. Population displacement within Mayendit and Panyijiar and from these counties to neighboring areas of Leer, Koch, Rumbek East, and Aweril is reportedly significant, but the scale is difficult to capture since many are informally residing with relatives and not officially registered in displacement sites. Damage to crops and the impacts on livestock production are also significant and widespread, preventing households from harvesting crops, earning income from agricultural labor, or conducting sales of crops, milk, or livestock.

Based on satellite-derived data on flood extent, inter-agency flood assessments, key informant interviews, and historical crop production data, crop losses are severe in Mayendit and Panyijiar and significant in low-lying areas of Leer and Mayom. Comparisons of the timing and severity of heavy rainfall and flood extent in 2020 and 2021 suggest crop production prospects for the annual harvest are worse this year compared to last year, though quantitative estimates are not yet available. In Mayendit, for example, approximately 90 percent of the land is submerged, including an estimated 222 farm plots ranging from 1 to 2 hectares in size on average, according to an August inter-agency assessment and other sources. In Mayom, key informants report that cattle raids earlier in the season also left little time to plant before the subsequent floods began. The loss of crops constitutes a significant loss of annual food and income for most households, even though production volumes in these agropastoral areas are low. According to 2014-2020 estimates by the annual Crop and Security Assessment Mission (CFSAM), Unity is already among the least agriculturally productive counties, accounting for only two percent of national net cereal production in 2020. Nevertheless, a recent study conducted by the Coalition for Humanity in April 2021 confirmed that crop production is the main source of income for 20 percent of households in Mayendit.

Various sources also suggest the floods have significantly disrupted livestock production activities, which is a primary or secondary source of food and income in these areas. In Mayendit, for example, reports from key informants confirm floods directly caused the death of at least 317 shoats and 525 cattle, though the scale of losses may be higher. Across all four counties, the inundation of pasture and browse and the contamination of water sources have disrupted seasonal livestock migration patterns, created heightened grazing pressure on remaining resources in highland cattle camps, and led to an increase in livestock disease incidence. Atypical migration, coupled with household displacement, usually manifests in reduced milk intake among women, children, and the elderly who do not travel with livestock. Since trade routes are flooded and markets submerged, effective demand for livestock is also currently very low. Based on the level of livestock ownership

Figure 9. Area of concern reference map: Leer, Mayendit, Mayom, and Panyijiar counties, Unity state



Source: FEWS NET

assessed in past FSNMS household surveys and REACH Area-of-Knowledge assessments, the negative impact on household food security is most significant in Mayom, where livestock production is the most important source of cash income for the purchase of cereal, followed by Panyijiar. In Leer and Mayendit, where most households lost their livestock during the 2013-2018 civil war, the floods have worsened access to milk at the market or from in-kind gifts.

Displacement and flooding have also increased the difficulty of other traditional livelihood activities in the short-term, including artisanal fishing, hunting, and gathering. On the one hand, the availability of these food sources peaks seasonally during and after the rainy season. Given the long-term reduction in crop and livestock production, many poor households have intensified their dependence on fishing and gathering wild foods (e.g., water lilies, palm tubers, nuts) over time, though this varies based on household knowledge and their access to fishing equipment. For instance, interviewed households in Mayendit estimated that wild foods constituted about 80 percent of their diet at the time of the [June 2021 REACH and WFP assessment](#). On the other hand, high water levels in the Nile River and in the Sudd Wetland make fishing more dangerous and reduce or cut off access to hunting and gathering grounds, making it very challenging for households to compensate for the loss of their main food sources. Overall, it is assessed that while some households are likely able to mitigate the impact of the flood shock on their food security with fish and other foods, there is likely a significant share of households that are unable to pursue or physically access these food sources.

The reduction in multiple food sources that can be sold for cash or traded for cereals, coupled with the scarcity of other income-earning opportunities, have lowered households' financial capacity to purchase food. This impact is exacerbated by the flooding of local trade routes and markets, which have lowered the market supply of staple foods and made physical access to markets more difficult. River transport of food commodities from source markets to local market hubs in Nyal in Panyijiar and Adok Port in Leer are still occurring, but the road connecting the Bentiu hub market to Leer, Mayendit, and Panyijiar is currently impassable. Consequently, household purchasing power has also declined due to rising food prices, which were already high due to national economic and supply factors. According to market monitoring information collected by FEWS NET field monitors in Mayendit and Leer in September, the retail price of red sorghum rose by 100-148 percent, while the amount of sorghum that a household could purchase with the sale of a small to medium-sized goat dropped by 49-55 percent compared to the same time last year. Market monitoring data is not consistently collected in Mayom or Panyijiar, but limited price data collected by government and humanitarian partners suggest similar trends are likely.

Levels of humanitarian food assistance under the lean season and flood response are significant in Leer and Panyijiar, but there are considerable challenges in assessing if food assistance is reaching the worst-affected households or if ration sizes are large enough to prevent large food consumption gaps at the household level. First, severe flooding poses logistical constraints on humanitarian access to some flood-affected areas and on household access to food distribution points, given that some flood-affected households are stranded in isolated areas. Second, there are concerns that many verified, flood-affected households are likely also hosting and sharing resources with IDP and refugee returnees who are not registered in WFP's biometric systems. REACH's fieldwork in June 2021 identified that many IDP and refugee returnees in Mayendit and Leer have not been registered since 2019 and are therefore ineligible to receive food assistance, and a similar trend is highly likely in Panyijiar. In addition, food assistance distribution cycles have been extended due to financial constraints, meaning that households received food assistance every 60 days instead of every 45 days under the lean season response. As a result, ration sizes are likely being spread very thin due to resource sharing within the greater household system of dependents. According to GFD and FFA distribution reports, humanitarian partners reached 25 and 35 percent of the county population in Leer and Panyijiar, respectively, between June and September; however, food assistance reached less than 25 percent of the population in Mayendit and Mayom. WFP's interim weekly reports indicate food assistance was prioritized for verified, flood-affected households but faced logistical constraints, reaching between 30 and 40 percent of verified households in Leer and Panyijiar and less than 10 percent of verified households in Mayom and Mayendit by October.

Based on past food insecurity data, the severity of current shocks, and the scarcity of current food and income sources, FEWS NET assesses that Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes are likely in Leer, Mayendit, Mayom, and Panyijiar. FSNMS R26 data collected at the start of the harvest period last year found that 45-85 percent of the population in each county experienced moderate hunger (HHS=3) in each county, while 7 percent in Leer, 6 percent in Mayom, and <2 percent in Mayendit and Mayom experienced severe hunger (HHS=4-6). At the peak of the following lean season [in June 2021, REACH reported](#) that key informants in over 80 percent of assessed settlements in Mayendit and Mayom said hunger was "severe or the worst it can be," while key informants in 41-60 percent of assessed settlements in Leer and Panyijiar said hunger was severe or extreme. Given the more extensive impact of flooding on food and income in 2021 compared to 2020, coupled with the erosion of coping capacity, it is expected that the severity of household food consumption gaps has only worsened since June and food assistance is inadequate to prevent Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes. Based on the severity of flood

impacts in 2021 and past trends in other worst-flood-affected areas in 2019 and 2020, it is likely that extreme food consumption gaps indicative of **Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5)** are occurring among flood-affected households in Mayendit, Leer, and Panyijiar who are isolated from food sources with no access to food assistance. In Mayom, where over 80 percent of the population owns livestock, this food source is more likely to mitigate extreme food gaps.

Assumptions

In addition to the national assumptions on pages 8-9, the most likely outcomes in this area are based on these assumptions:

- Based on severe to significant damage to crops, the 2021 main season harvest is anticipated to be below last year and the five-year average in all four counties. In Mayendit, the likelihood of crop failure among many households is high.
- Low trade and market activity, low local cereal production, and low effective demand is expected to suppress the market cereal supply, keeping staple food prices high and above-average through at least December. A relative decline is expected in 2022 as floodwaters gradually recede and roads re-open, especially in Leer, where Adok Port is located. Prices are expected to be lower than last year but above the five-year average due to macroeconomic and supply factors.
- Livestock holdings will likely stagnate or decline due to flood-related drivers of hunger and disease, suppressing recovery of this food and income source during the dry season among households that still own livestock. Past trends indicate inter-communal cattle raids between Panyijiar and Mayom and neighboring Warrap, Lakes, and southern Unity counties are also likely to affect livestock and milk production. However, given the scale of livestock ownership and the lesser severity of flooding, livestock production in Mayom is likely to have a better recovery compared to the other counties.
- In June 2021, WFP planned to deliver food assistance to about 35-70 percent of the respective county populations in Mayendit, Leer, and Panyijiar and none in Mayom between October and January. However, the national scale of food assistance needs in flood-affected areas has likely led to resource re-allocations. This scenario assumes approximately 30 percent of the population will likely receive food assistance in Mayendit, Leer, and Panyijiar based on WFP's flood tracking plan, and less than 20 percent of the population will receive food assistance in Mayom. This scenario assumes no food assistance delivery from February to May since food assistance plans are not yet available.

Most Likely Food Security Outcomes

From October to January, many flood-affected and returnee households will likely still have large food consumption gaps due to significantly below-average crop production, high cereal prices linked to low market supply, and few alternative food and income sources. As a result, Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes are expected during the harvesting period in Mayendit, Leer, and Panyijiar. Despite planned food distributions, it is unlikely all targeted beneficiaries will be reached given prevailing logistical constraints and inaccessibility to isolated, flood-displaced households in these areas, as evidenced by recent distribution reports. Resource-sharing between recipient households and unregistered households may increase the reach of food assistance but also dilute the impact of planned ration sizes. Given the scale of the impacts of flooding on food sources, as well as periodic threats of conflict, past trends suggest some households in these three counties will be entirely dependent on wild foods and likely face extreme food consumption gaps indicative of Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5). In Mayom, however, a lower flood extent is expected to improve feeder roads conditions by November. As such, the functionality of local markets and market supply are expected to improve with the onset of the dry season, permitting the sale of livestock and products to gradually resume and provide some income to purchase food. While this will mitigate the severity of food consumption gaps, many poor and flood-affected households are still likely to engage in crisis coping strategies to compensate for inadequate food and income, indicative of Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes.

From February to May, which encompasses the post-harvest period and the start of the 2022 lean season, the main driver of acute food insecurity will be the earlier-than-normal depletion of household harvest stocks. Additionally, the seasonal availability of livestock products will decline, corresponding to reduced rangeland and livestock migration away from homesteads to dry-season grazing areas. However, in all areas, markets and trade are expected to seasonally recover as feeder roads continue to dry out. Additionally, the availability of both fish and wild foods will likely be normal in most accessible areas. These latter improvements are likely to partially offset the exhausted harvest, but ultimately result in persistent Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes in Mayendit, Leer, and Panyijiar and Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes in Mayom. Food assistance is not yet planned for this period. Again, past trends suggest some pockets of the worst-flood-affected and displaced households will likely be in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) if they have no harvest or livestock, missed-out biometric registration, and depend on wild foods, especially in Mayendit and Panyijiar. The likelihood of Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) is expected to decline in Leer, however, given its location near Adok Port that offers relatively better market activity and related income-earning activities for households that do not have land or livestock.

Jonglei and Upper Nile states: Fangak, Ayod, and Canal/Pigi counties (SS06: Eastern Plains Sorghum and Cattle livelihood zone) and Manyo, Fashoda, Panyikang, Melut, Baliet, and Malakal counties (SS11: Northern Sorghum and Livestock livelihood zone) (Figure 11)

Current Situation

In northern Jonglei and western Upper Nile, renewed political conflict and a third consecutive year of floods are exacerbating the severity of acute food insecurity at the start of the 2021 harvest. Due to the impact of episodic conflict and significant flooding in 2019 and 2020 on their food and income sources, most households in this area were already experiencing moderate to large food consumption gaps during the 2021 lean season. Following the [Kitgwang Declaration on August 4th](#) and the subsequent [resignation of the SPLM/A-IO deputy chair](#) to form the Kitgwang faction, internal division within the SPLM/A-IO has led to an increase in violence. Manyo county is the epicenter of the conflict, where armed clashes have claimed civilian lives, displaced at least 230 households, and disrupted local livelihood and humanitarian activities, especially in Kitgwang (Magenis border area) and Khor Amut areas. The violence has also had broader regional impacts by forcing the closure of the Fashoda-Manyo-Magenis road that links to Sudan and restricting trade to the Nile River route. There is concern that conflict could spread southward within Upper Nile and to northern Jonglei, as highlighted by the defection of a group of SPLM/A-IO soldiers in Longochuck to the SSPDF on September 4th and clashes in Uror on October 1st. While peace talks are underway between the government of South Sudan and the Kitgwang faction of the SPLM/A-IO, delays are expected given the facilitation role of the Sudanese government and events of the recent military coup in Khartoum.

Figure 11. Area of concern reference map: Fangak, Ayod, and Canal/Pigi of Jonglei and Manyo, Fashoda, Panyikang, Melut, Baliet, and Malakal of Upper Nile



In this area of concern, the scale of flooding in 2021 exceeds that of the 2020 floods, especially in northern Jonglei, where flooding has caused further loss of livestock and crops and repeated displacement in areas that already saw significant losses in 2020. Based on an IRNA conducted in early September, an estimated 56,504 people (about 10 percent of the population) were affected by floods in Manyo, Fashoda, Malakal, and Panyikang. The report identified the loss of several houses, crop fields, and livestock, and concern for disease outbreaks given standing water and limited WASH facilities. Additionally, due to the destruction of markets and lack of access to markets in displacement sites, there is a shortage of food. Women, children, and elderly people are identified as among the worst-affected. Flooding also caused significant damage in Fangak, Canal/Pigi, and Ayod. Fangak is of highest concern, where an estimated 94,000 people (50 percent of the population) were affected by floods and are displaced and now living in temporary IDP settlements in Patai, Fulbuot, Pieth, and Duod in Old Fangak. An IRNA conducted in late August reported visual assessment of weakness among some children and elderly, reportedly due to inadequate food consumption. In Canal/Pigi, an estimated 35,000 people were displaced to highland areas and humanitarian access was temporarily cut off. In Ayod, an estimated 31,000 people were displaced from Haat and Pakur to several islands, including Quenyapul and TamTam. Flooding also destroyed the health clinic in Haat, and MSF has reported high levels of acute malnutrition among flood-affected populations.

The 2021 harvests are assessed to be significantly below average due not only to flood-induced crop losses in 2021, but also the expansion of wetland on the land available for cultivation since 2018, most notably in Canal/Pigi, Ayod, and Fangak of Jonglei and Panyikang of Upper Nile. Currently, high water levels have destroyed and submerged many crops, though the impact varies by the stage of crop development at the time of the floods and the location of fields. In Fangak, Canal/Pigi, and Ayod, field assessments have confirmed crops are in very poor condition, having been destroyed or submerged in floodwaters. Furthermore, some farmers did not plant in 2021 given residual floods from 2020. Significant crop losses are expected in Fangak and Ayod, with many not expecting a harvest. Conversely, in Fashoda, crops were at the flowering stage when flooding occurred, and have managed to remain in good condition for harvest. Similarly, floods had relatively less of an impact in Manyo, where households may harvest a few months of stocks.

Livestock ownership and access to livestock products are also below normal in flood-affected areas, and these losses come on top of years of conflict-related losses. In flood-affected counties such as Fashoda, there are reports of livestock movement to higher grounds away from population displacement sites and areas with contaminated water, lowering

household access to livestock products. In Fangak, Canal/Pigi, and western Ayod, several IRNA conducted between July and September reported significant livestock losses linked to disease or lack of pastures. As such, the contribution of livestock to food and incomes among households in these counties has declined even further relative to early 2021. However, households who own livestock and reside in areas less affected by flooding – such as Baliet and Melut – have relatively normal access to livestock products as livestock are near homesteads and in generally average condition.

Due to the significant reduction in access to key income sources such as the sale of crops and livestock, many households are seeking what income they can earn through alternative sources, including fishing and wild foods. Field assessments report that fishing along the Nile and Sobat rivers, seasonal streams, and floodwaters is a key food source currently. An IRNA conducted in Fashoda in late August confirms flooding has increased fish availability, while an IRNA in late August in flood-affected areas of Fangak, Ayod, and Canal/Pigi found high dependence on fish, wild foods, and food assistance. Although households are engaged in fishing and drying fish for sale to buy cereals, many of the displaced still lack fishing tools and canoes, somewhat limiting their capacity to fully engage in fishing. Furthermore, FSNMS data from late 2020 found a high share of female-headed households, ranging from 55 to over 80 percent in the counties of concern; given that many women have historically less experience fishing, it's considered less likely these households are able to engage in fishing at the same rates as many male-headed households.

Trade flows and market functioning vary but are generally significantly disrupted or hosting minimal to no activity, resulting in high staple food prices. Informal trade flows between Sudan and South Sudan through Magenit have halted due to the ongoing SPLM/A-IO clashes. The closure of the trade route, and deterioration in the physical road conditions of other routes due to heavy flooding, have negatively affected market supply. River transportation via the Nile or Sobat rivers is ongoing, though this remains risky due to the uptick in insecurity which can entail illegal taxes or looting of goods. Reports also suggest that many traders have relocated to other safer places. An assessment by MSF in July/August in northern Jonglei found no functioning market in Ayod and only small markets in New Fangak and Canal/Pigi at the peak of the floods, with very limited or no cereal supply. These disruptions are driving high and increasing staple food prices. For example, in Fashoda of Upper Nile, the retail price of white flour increased from 520 SSP/kg in August to 580 SSP in September.

Humanitarian food assistance is available in several of these counties of concern, but assistance levels are generally low, currently prioritized for the flood response, and constrained by access and funding challenges. According to WFP's distribution reports, average monthly food assistance between July and September reached under 10 percent of the population in Canal/Pigi, Fashoda, Manyo, Panyikang, and Melut and between 10 and 20 percent of the population in Fangak, Ayod, Malakal, and Baliet. However, available flood response information shows that humanitarian response is likely reaching most accessible flood-affected households in Fashoda, Ayod, and Malakal. Large gaps in access may be occurring in Fangak, however, as only 18,500 people (around 20 percent) of the flood-affected population have received assistance. Although humanitarian response is ongoing, critical gaps in response exist due to funding and logistical constraints. It is likely some of the population in need of assistance may not be reached given the scale of the flooding, such as in Fangak.

Data on food consumption and livelihood coping was last collected in late 2020, at which time food insecurity was already widespread. Field assessments conducted during September and October 2021 suggest it is highly likely that food security has further deteriorated due to the increase in conflict and another year of flooding. In late 2020, data on food consumption, livelihood coping, and acute malnutrition supported that Crisis (IPC Phase 3) or Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes were ongoing in these areas of concern. Given the impacts of flooding, the harvest generally lasted no longer than February or March of 2021, and households mainly relied on hunting, gathering wild foods, and some humanitarian food assistance to mitigate food consumption gaps. Now, based on the varying severity of reported conflict and flood impacts on the harvest and other food sources, it is likely that Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes are occurring in Fangak, Ayod, Canal/Pigi, Panyikang, and Manyo and Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes are occurring in Malakal, Baliet, and Melut. In northern Jonglei, specifically, past trends suggest some of the worst-flood-affected households who lost their entire crops or livestock, lack access to food assistance, or have no access to physical markets are likely in Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5).

Although the most recent nutrition data from SMART surveys are not available for all the counties of concern, an analysis of the past nutrition surveys points to an overall 'Critical' (GAM 15-29.9%) level of acute malnutrition. Field assessments conducted in late August to September indicate worsening nutrition outcomes among the under-five children due to reduced food access linked to flood-and-conflict induced displacement and loss of livestock and crops, water contamination, and disruption to health and nutrition services. According to REACH's assessment conducted in June, 81-100 percent of key informants reported the presence of visibly malnourished children in Ayod, Canal/Pigi, Baliet, and Melut, and 41-60 percent of key informants reported such in Fangak, prior to flooding in July/August. MUAC screenings conducted by MSF in Liengieri, Rubgar, Quimiyapul, and Tamtam of western Ayod in mid-August, covering 222 children under the age of five, found a GAM

by MUAC proportion of 26 percent among screened children. While in Fangak, reports indicate that nutrition facilities such as OTP/TSFP sites have been relocated to higher grounds or closed down. As a result, morbidity and mortality rates of MAM and SAM cases among children under age five have likely increased; seasonal morbidity increase during wet seasons and usual disease outbreaks from flooding are expected to have further contributed to worsening levels of acute malnutrition.

Assumptions

In addition to the national-level assumptions on pages 8-9, the most likely outcomes from October 2021 to May 2022 for areas of concern in Jonglei and Upper Nile are based on the following assumptions:

- Based on the continued internal divisions and defections within SPLM/A-IO forces in September, further defections are likely amidst [peace talks with the government](#), with a high likelihood for further sporadic attacks. This will likely continue to disrupt the main season harvest, trade flows from Sudan, and trade flows and assistance delivery through riverine routes, especially between Renk and Malakal. The attacks are also likely to result in new and repeated displacement, putting additional pressure on already scarce food and income sources in the places they are likely to be displaced to.
- Linked to the disruption to trade flows and general state of conflict and insecurity, market functioning is also likely to be periodically disrupted, including interior markets in Fashoda, Panyikang, Melut, Malakal, and Baliet that rely on from trade flows from Sudan via Manyo or Renk, and markets in parts of Fangak and Canal/Pigi which rely on trade flows through the Sobat corridors from Ethiopia. Market functioning may remain minimal to no activity at least through February/March due to residual floodwaters—before improving from April towards May when floodwaters may have receded. Overall, staple food prices are likely to remain above last year and their five-year average.
- Given the expectation for sporadic attacks, livestock lootings or cattle raids are likely to spike during the dry season especially in areas that will experience heavy fighting. While some households will lose livestock to looting, others will have difficulty maintaining livestock health amid poor pasture from standing floodwaters.
- In June 2021, WFP planned to deliver food assistance to 55 percent of the county population in Ayod from October to December, but a lack of funding prohibited plans in other counties. Given the current flood response and revision to the national emergency food assistance plan, this scenario assumes some additional food assistance will likely be provided to less than 20 percent of population in the other counties. This scenario assumes no food assistance delivery from February to May since food assistance plans are not yet available.

Most Likely Food Security Outcomes

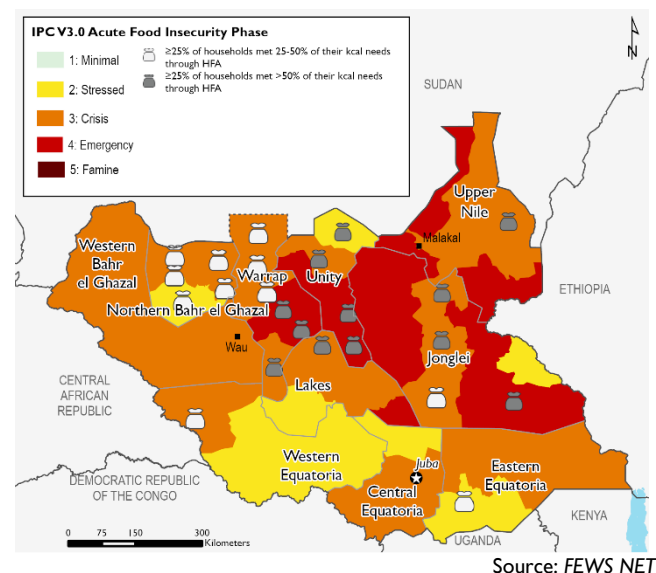
Between October and January, food insecurity is expected to remain severe in Manyo, Fashoda, Panyikang, Fangak, Ayod, and Canal/Pigi due to the scale of conflict and flood impacts on household harvests, market supplies, and other food sources. In Melut, Baliet, and Malakal, where the impact of floods on crops and livestock are broadly less severe, but conflict is likely to continue to have regional effects and restrict trade, Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes will likely be sustained. Counties in northern Jonglei, including Fangak, Ayod, and Canal/Pigi, are of highest concern. In these areas, large populations will likely have very limited harvests with very low coping capacity, given that the flood-related loss of livestock and other assets has compounded the erosion of local livelihoods over preceding years of conflict. In Fangak and Canal/Pigi, the scale of planned food assistance will likely be inadequate to prevent Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes. In Ayod, food assistance is expected to be critical to alleviating food consumption gaps for many households, likely leading to Crisis! (IPC Phase 3!). Still, due to the severity of the shock and based on past trends observed in severely flood-affected areas in 2019 and 2020, Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) outcomes are likely among some households in Fangak, Canal/Pigi, and Ayod who are unable to harvest, do not own livestock, primarily rely on wild foods, and do not have access to assistance.

During the February to May post-harvesting period and the start of the lean season, when no food assistance is planned, the size of the population in Emergency (IPC Phase 4) is likely to increase across the area of concern, and Ayod is expected to deteriorate to Emergency (IPC Phase 4). In general, harvest food stocks will become depleted among the population that was able to harvest. Meanwhile, receding floodwaters will permit a relative increase in population movement and their ability to seek out food and income sources. However, sporadic attacks are likely to persist in the hotspot areas of Manyo, Fashoda, and Panyikang of Upper Nile, continuing to regionally restrict market and trade activity in adjacent counties. Based on the assumption that SPLM/A-IO conflict will spread but remain sporadic, Crisis (IPC Phase 3) outcomes are expected in Melut, Baliet, and Malakal. However, in an alternative scenario where conflict intensifies, then worse outcomes could occur. Meanwhile, Emergency (IPC Phase 4) outcomes will likely persist in Manyo, Fashoda, Panyikang, Fangak, Ayod, and Canal/Pigi. In northern Jonglei, Catastrophe (IPC Phase 5) is likely in the absence of humanitarian food assistance.

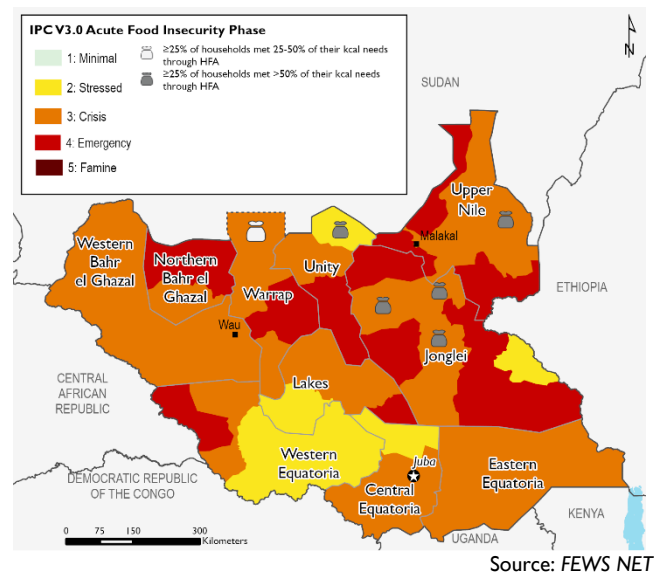
MOST LIKELY FOOD SECURITY OUTCOMES AND AREAS RECEIVING SIGNIFICANT LEVELS OF HUMANITARIAN ASSISTANCE*

Each of these maps adheres to IPC v3.0 humanitarian assistance mapping protocols and flags where significant levels of humanitarian assistance are being/are expected to be provided. ☼ indicates that at least 25 percent of households receive on average 25–50 percent of caloric needs from humanitarian food assistance (HFA). ☼ indicates that at least 25 percent of households receive on average over 50 percent of caloric needs through HFA. This mapping protocol differs from the (!) protocol used in the maps at the top of the report. The use of (!) indicates areas that would likely be at least one phase worse in the absence of current or programmed humanitarian assistance.

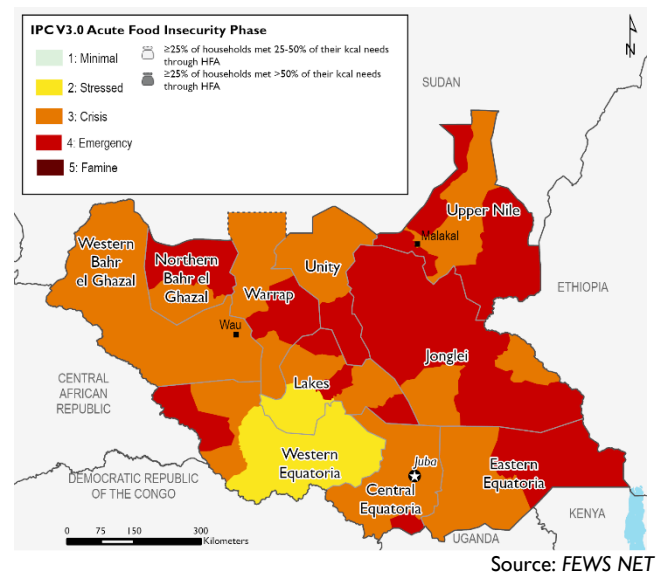
Current, October 2021



Projected food security outcomes, October 2021 to January 2022



Projected food security outcomes, January to May 2022



FEWS NET classification is IPC-compatible. IPC-compatible analysis follows key IPC protocols but does not necessarily reflect the consensus of national food security partners.

FEWS NET: South Sudan Food Security Outlook October 2021 to May 2022: Emergency (IPC Phase 4) likely to continue in areas severely affected by conflict and floods, 2021.

ABOUT SCENARIO DEVELOPMENT

To project food security outcomes, FEWS NET develops a set of assumptions about likely events, their effects, and the probable responses of various actors. FEWS NET analyzes these assumptions in the context of current conditions and local livelihoods to arrive at a most likely scenario for the coming eight months. [Learn more here.](#)